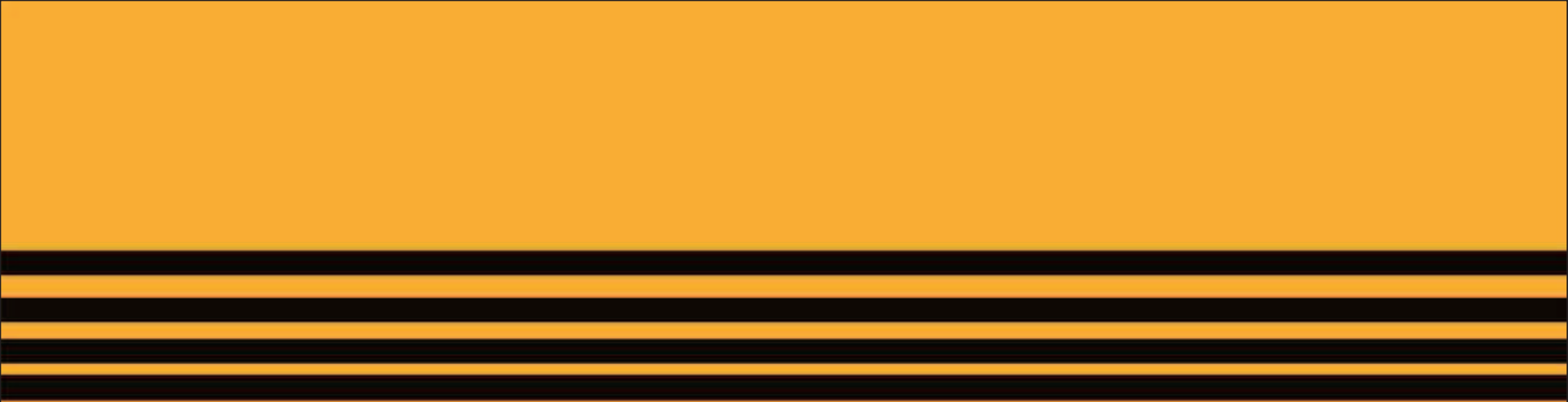




THE ATOMIC AGE 1895–1945

The unanticipated discovery of radioactivity revealed that massive amounts of energy are hidden inside atoms, available to be unleashed. New and surprising theories of relativity and quantum mechanics described a Universe of four-dimensional space-time containing interchangeable waves and particles that, at the subatomic level, can never be pinned down with absolute certainty.